How to Book Meetings on LinkedIn by Charlotte Johnson

Charly x 30 Minutes to President's Club

Hey team, Charly here crashing the 30 Minutes to President's Club Party.

Booking meetings on LinkedIn isn't as easy as it used to be. This channel is becoming more and more saturated with our prospects being bombarded daily by sales pitches. So to stand out, I take a slightly different approach to using this channel successfully.

Here are the 3 steps I take to:

1. **Find accounts & prospects:** Setting ourselves up for success.
2. **Conduct detective work:** Increasing connect rates & defining messaging.
3. **Create messaging:** For Teamlink intros, new job changes, & nurturing.

So let's get crack-a-lacking!

About Charly

Charly is an AE at Salesloft, she was the top-performing SDR and as an AE continuously tries new tactics & strategies to help her build pipeline.

If you like what you see, get more of Charly's content by following her on LinkedIn here.

Finding Accounts & Prospects

The easiest way to book meetings is by finding accounts & prospects who are more likely to reply.

You probably have all used CRM closed-lost reports to find quick wins, and in my opinion, what I'm going to share is the closed-lost equivalent in Linkedin.

It's as easy as 1,2,3 with some simple filters in Sales Navigator.

Here's how to do it:

Upload Your Accounts

We'll first need to upload your account list into Sales Navigator.

1. Download your account list from your CRM
2. Under the "Accounts" tab in Sales Navigator, click "Upload Accounts" and follow the instructions on the screen.
3. Name your list and you're ready to go!

Find The Accounts & Prospects

Finding Accounts: Toggle the "Buyer Intent" column and look for accounts with the highest intent score. This intent score ranges from people in that company looking at competitors to employees looking at your company page.

Finding People: Then, create a lead filter & add your account list under the "workflow" column. Edit the seniority to only show prospects you will target in your accounts. There are some really valuable other options under "Spotlight" but these three "Spotlight" Filters have contributed to the most booked meetings for me.

1. **TeamLink intro:** This shows people from your company who are connected to your prospects on LinkedIn. In this situation, I would get the person from my company to message my prospect on LinkedIn. People are more likely to reply if they know of the person messaging them.
2. **Recently changed jobs:** People usually move to a new company for a reason, maybe they're tasked with a certain project or achieving some chunky goals so they are potentially more open to a conversation.
3. **Follows your company:** These are simply people who follow your company on LinkedIn. These prospects will be more familiar with your offering (maybe they've even purchased it before) and therefore are more likely to respond.

Detective Work

There are 2 challenges when we are reaching out to prospects on LinkedIn.

1. They might not accept our connection request
2. We will guess the challenges & focus' they have

Both can be influenced by doing a lil bit of detective work, here's how you do it:

Increase Connection Rates

Here we are going to do some "groundswell" work. And when I say "groundswell", I simply mean, during the research stage to add the lower-level employees on LinkedIn. For me, I target sales so I will add all of the team on LinkedIn with a blank invite.

This benefits me in 2 ways

1. When I connect with my prospect I'll have mutual connections which increases the chance of them accepting
2. I can do some detective work...

Find Some Clues

Now it's time to do some detective work with the people who accept our connection request.

Here I wouldn't message too many people. Colleagues talk at the end of the day. It's also important to read the room a bit here. If someone is messaging back blunt answers and closed then I won't keep asking questions.

Below is an example of how a conversation with a more chatty/open person could go.

Template	Example
Me: Hey **[First Name]**, you don't know me but can I ask a random question? Me: Thanks for helping me out, **[Personalization]** + **[Question]?** Me: Feel free to tell me to bugger off, but I'm about to send an email to **[Prospect Name]**. My email so far mentions **[Personalization]** **[Challenge/Focus]**. Is this completely off or is this something the team is talking about improving in your team meetings?"	Me: Hey Mark, you don't know me but can I ask a random question? Them: Yes.. Me: Thanks for helping me out, when we spoke to the team last year the SDRs were struggling with using your CRM to prospect consistently, you still just using your CRM for prospecting? Them: Yes, actually we didn't move forward with a prospecting tool. Me: Feel free to tell me to bugger off, but I'm about to send an email to Billybob Johnson. My email so far mentions the new leadership changes & hiring in the SDR team, with this guessing increasing pipeline gen meetings might be a focus. Is this completely off or is this something the team is talking about improving in your team meetings? Them: This is definitely still something they're trying to improve.

Messaging

Now that you've got 1. Some mutual connections & 2. A better understanding of their challenges - let's start utilizing our newfound leverage in our outbound messaging.

Messaging: TeamLink Intro

So using the instructions from earlier, we've found a prospect is connected to someone at our company. Depending on how well they know them will depend on the messaging to use. But below is an example where they know them-ish (briefly worked together, met at an event, etc).

Template	Example
Hey **[Name]** - How are things? We **[Insert connection context]**. Great to see **[Personalization]**. We've been speaking with **[Roles]** who are focused on **[Challenge you solve]**. Is this something the team is thinking about? Either way, great to see **[Personalization]**, sounds like a really exciting time at **[Company]** **- [Your name]**	Hey Billybob - How are things? We worked together briefly at Klaviyo if you remember? Great to see the hiring going on in the AE team! We've been speaking with VPs who are struggling to get insight into the health of their team's deals, meaning they're unable to spot risks before it's too late. Is this something the team is thinking about? Either way, great to see growth in the team, sounds like a really exciting time at SaaSco. - CJ

Messaging: Changed jobs

You know when it's your birthday and you get about 34042 messages. It's hard to keep up with them and they get a bit annoying after a while. And there's always that 1 person who messages a few days late and you get to have a proper conversation with them as you're not drowning in messages anymore

Well it's pretty much the same when someone moves roles. They get hammered with messages but what we forget to realize is the other 101 things happening when you move jobs (learning the product, meeting the team, etc). So although it's a great trigger to use I approach it slightly differently by acknowledging how busy they are.

Template	Example
Hey **[Name]** , You're probably getting absolutely battered by sales reps with the recent job change. Don't worry, I won't be that person haha. Found **[Personalization]** interesting but will ping you in a couple of weeks to expand. - **[Your name]** P.S. CONGRATS!!	Hey Bob, You're probably getting absolutely battered by sales reps with the recent job change. Don't worry, I won't be that person haha. Found the article your CRO wrote about expansion into the US interesting but will ping you in a couple of weeks to expand. - Charly P.S. CONGRATS!!

Messaging: Nurture Approach

Once a prospect accepts on LinkedIn, most reps will just go in for the kill. Even if it's personalised and highlighting challenges it's still trying to book them in for that meeting. Although this used to work, it's not as successful today in my opinion.

So instead of this approach, my goal is to get them used to replying to me by taking a nurture approach.

Pro tip: try to use external content to add more credibility.

Template	Example 1
[Personalization], [First Name]. **[Challenge]** **[Offer content relevant to the challenge]** - Want me to share?	*"Aggressively build the "top" of the sales funnel" - reading your job bio in your LinkedIn, Bob.* Salesloft & Benchmarkit did a study where 55% of companies shared pipeline gen was the biggest struggle. If it's the same challenge for the team, want me to share the process I used that helped me produce 200K of pipeline last month?
	Example 2
	Great to see so many recent SDR hires, Bob. If they're struggling to get replies, I recently came across this really cool free AI tool that helps write emails - want me to share it?

And that’s a wrap!

Here’s where you can get more of where that came from.

Those meetings aren’t gonna book themselves, so go put 'em to work!

And if you found the above useful you can follow me on LinkedIn here to stay up to date with my tips & tactics around booking meetings.

Thanks for reading!

Charly